

Interviewer: [00:00:04] Yes, Mr. [Name], thank you very much for participating in the interview again, as we mentioned in the message we sent, we would like to learn more about your ideas about romantic relationships and we think that your experience and your perspective will be very helpful for the project. Before we start, let me ask you again, is it okay for me to record this interview?

Speaker: [00:00:23] It is appropriate.

Interviewer: [00:00:25] We will only use this recording for transcription and note taking.

Interviewer: [00:00:30] First of all, how old are you?

Speaker: [00:00:32] I'm [21-25] years old.

Interviewer: [00:00:35] How long have you been with your partner?

Speaker: [00:00:38] It's been over [1-5] years, about [1-5] years.

Interviewer: [00:00:42] Do you have children?

Speaker: [00:00:43] No.

Interviewer: [00:00:44] Excuse me one second. Who do you live with at home?

Speaker: [00:00:50] I live with my friend.

Interviewer: [00:00:00] What is your main source of income Mr. [Name] or if you have a current job?

Speaker: [00:01:00] Pardon?

Interviewer: [00:01:04] I asked about your main source of income and your current job?

Speaker: [00:01:07] I'm a student now. I'm supported by my family, I also work in the summers, I'm also saving for the winter months, extra, myself.

Interviewer: [00:01:23] Mr. [Name], how would you like us to address your parties: girlfriend, wife, lover, partner. Which one?

Speaker: [00:01:32] Let's call her girlfriend.

Interviewer: [00:01:35] Okay. Can you tell me the story of how you met your girlfriend and how you started your relationship?

[Portion Redacted]

Interviewer: [00:03:00] So how would you rate the quality of your relationship compared to your friends' relationships?

Speaker: [00:03:08] I mean any kind of comparison, like a scoring or something like that?

Interviewer: [00:03:14] So it doesn't have to be a score. You can express it verbally in the same way as how you actually think about it, how you think about it, you can express it verbally in the same way, it can be more like this, it can be less like this, you know, how you actually think about it?

Speaker: [00:03:32] I think it is higher especially within the framework of respect.

Speaker: [00:03:38] I mean, I don't doubt our love ["Love" in native language], and of course the people around me are also like that in their relationships, I mean, if I need to differentiate, I think especially within the framework of respect and understanding.

Interviewer: [00:03:57] So, do you want to elaborate a little bit more on why you say that?

Speaker: [00:04:01] Both of us, you know, I think that there are people that both of us will think a lot, I think that's probably the main source, I mean, we care about our thoughts, you know, we care about our ideas, what we want to do, our future plans, our wishes, our desires.

Interviewer: [00:04:27] Can I also ask you how many romantic relationships have you had in the past?

Speaker: [00:04:30] No, except for this one.

Interviewer: [00:04:35] Okay. So what makes a relationship high quality for you?

Speaker: [00:04:43] First of all, of course, I think that love ["Love" in native language] and respect should be at the highest level.

Speaker: [00:04:50] Apart from that, I think that our perspectives on life, how to put it, our expectations from life or what we think about the future, what we dream about, you know, partners should match.

Interviewer: [00:05:12] So what makes high quality for you? Oh sorry, what makes it low quality? Interviewer.

Speaker: [00:05:20] What makes it low quality.

Speaker: [00:05:23] What makes low quality can be this: If there is no understanding in the relationship or if there is a miscommunication between people, if everyone continues to behave on their own, if there is no listening situation, I think that miscommunication can reduce the quality. After all, as in human affairs, in romantic relationships, the most important factor is to listen to each other, to understand each other, so I think that miscommunication can cause especially differences of opinion.

Interviewer: [00:06:09] You mentioned that the things that actually make the relationship high quality are love, respect and a little bit more common outlook on life, would you like to elaborate a little bit more on why you say that?

Speaker: [00:06:20] Let me start with love ["Love" in native language] and respect, you know, if one partner has a higher level of love ["Love" in native language] and the other partner has a lower level of love ["Love" in native language], there may be a different kind of attachment, so the person with the lower level of love ["Love" in native language] or the person with the higher level of love ["Love" in native language] may have a different approach.

Speaker: [00:06:42] But if these are in a common framework, of course, the approaches will be the same. It is the same for respect. The level of respect expected from others may be different. If there is a difference in these, the other person may be offended more quickly or feel more worthless, insignificant. So with this, I think it should be formed at a common level. As a perspective on life, I can express it as follows. You know, we all have levels that we want to

come to, that we want to reach, for our future life, for our academic achievements or for the positions we want to be in life, but if these are at very different levels, people may not be able to keep up with each other at this point, so I think this is important.

Interviewer: [00:07:58] So, would you say that in close relationships, strong relationships, life is actually communication, understanding and actually being listened to, which is a little bit more in line with what you said?

Speaker: [00:08:07] In general.

Interviewer: [00:08:21] Well, I want to go through the qualifications that you gave as an example of high quality, how can a person understand that a person is in a relationship where the level of love and respect is the same, where the perspectives, the expectations for the future are parallel?

Speaker: [00:08:45] I mean, I think one can understand by looking at the examples around, or according to the situations he/she experiences during the day, if after spending a day, after sharing, according to the situations approached.

Speaker: [00:09:02] I can give examples like this, according to how happy and peaceful she feels next to her partner, or according to the importance demanded.

Interviewer: [00:09:17] So, when would you say that your relationship is most, when or when would you say directly that there is a common parallel of this love and respect and perspectives, if you take an example from your own relationship.

Speaker: [00:09:32] Or when it accessed it?

Interviewer: [00:09:35] I mean, we're actually asking when it happened, but we can go through how you want to evaluate it or we can go through other things in the same way, you can give an example of understanding communication in the same way.

Speaker: [00:09:52] I mean, I didn't think that we were on very different levels from the beginning of the relationship.

Speaker: [00:09:59] So at least I can say that I felt that way from the beginning.

Interviewer: [00:10:05] Well, I would like to know if there was a time when it was the least, when it was the least. You know that...

Speaker: [00:10:12] It didn't really have it.

Interviewer: [00:10:18] So what are the most important things in a relationship for you Mr. [Name]?

Speaker: [00:10:23] The most important things.

Speaker: [00:10:25] I can give an example of the most important things. You know, I can say spending quality time.

Speaker: [00:10:34] I would say being able to leave happy with the result of what we do together. I mean, if we are spending time together and I can feel happy, if I can find peace, if I can distract myself, if I can get rid of the tiredness of the day, that's important for me.

Interviewer: [00:10:59]Would you like to elaborate a little bit more on why you say that, that it's actually important for you to be able to leave happy, to have a peaceful and distracting relationship.

Speaker: [00:11:11]Because without these things, you know, we all have a certain life outside of our partners, and in these lives, we may have problems, problems and so on.

Speaker: [00:11:25]In the end, if I can't spend quality time with my partner and laugh and have fun, how can I put it, of course, the only reason why I am in a relationship is not that I experience these things, of course, but if I can overcome the tension and tiredness of the day with my partner, of course, if we can overcome it together, I can say that if I can be happy like this, if I can be peaceful, I can say that's why.

Interviewer: [00:11:59]So what is love to you?

Speaker: [00:12:07]To me love is... I mean I would say it is happiness and peace.

Interviewer: [00:12:26]Actually, you mentioned a little bit about these, but I would be very happy if you could expand a little bit more on these concepts.

Speaker: [00:12:34]Do you mind if I think about it?

Interviewer: [00:12:35]Not at all. Please take as much time as you want.

Speaker: [00:12:51]So I can express it like this: When I look at the person in front of me, if I can experience this, or when I have such a need, when I need a hug or a hug after a bad day, for example, when we experience this, when I need peace, if I can experience this.

Speaker: [00:13:25]If I can laugh freely, if I can be myself, if I know that I will never be judged, if I know that I can overcome my problems together, that's love (aşk) for me.

Interviewer: [00:13:44]How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: [00:13:48]I think it is very important. It's too important. Because when we lose, I mean, it may have been lost with the things that would have made the relationship very complete.

Interviewer: [00:14:05] So how do you know if your girlfriend loves you, Mr. [Name]?

Speaker: [00:14:11] You know, the concepts of happiness that I mentioned before, the concepts of what is important and what is not important, you know, I'm actually going to repeat it here again, but

Interviewer: [00:14:22] please repeat

Speaker: [00:14:28] For example, now I see that we can share our happiness in a respectful and loving ["Love" in native language] way, where we can share our troubles. When I have a problem, without hesitation, I can find peace with her again, I can be myself. I can be happy with these. I can spend quality time. I know that she can always be behind me. This is how I can understand that she loves me.

Interviewer: [00:15:00] what would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker: [00:15:11] I might have to think about it a little bit.

Interviewer: [00:15:12] Here you go

Speaker: [00:15:29] I mean, we don't have an extreme difficulty, but if I need to give an example, of course, we all have our own lives, so sometimes there are situations where we have difficulty in allocating time for each other, for example, I can give this example for now.

Interviewer: [00:15:49] So, do you and your girlfriend fight?

Speaker: [00:15:51] Yes

Interviewer: [00:15:54] Could you tell me how often these fights happen?

Speaker: [00:16:03] I mean, how can I put it, of course, it can change from time to time, I mean, but I wouldn't say very often, I mean a medium level, for example, [1-5] month, for example.

Interviewer: [00:16:28] What are the fights about?

Speaker: [00:16:34] these fights are usually about.. I need to think for a second

Interviewer: [00:16:45] sure, go ahead.

Speaker: [00:16:48] Okay. I mean, sometimes our approaches to things can be different. For example, I am not a very meticulous person, for example, my girlfriend is a very meticulous person.

Speaker: [00:17:17] Let's say we had a disagreement over this, we had a fight. These are small things of course. It becomes prolonged. I want to talk very quickly and settle it, and sometimes my girlfriend wants to give some time for that. There is a bit of disagreement between us about this. Usually this is why our fights get to a position to prolong. I can usually say that it is because of this.

Interviewer: [00:17:47] So how do you resolve these fights?

Speaker: [00:17:53] So, sometimes we solve it by talking. Sometimes we solve it by ignoring it depending on the situation.

Speaker: [00:18:04] So it can change.

Interviewer: [00:18:09] Actually, you mentioned a little bit that talking and communication are important in a relationship. Apart from these, what are the other ways to maintain a relationship?

Speaker: [00:18:32] So I think other ways of maintaining a relationship, for example, when there is no communication, it is understanding, so I can talk a little bit about empathy. For example, we may not always be at a level to communicate. This time, I think we can maintain some things by understanding our partner or putting ourselves in their shoes.

Interviewer: [00:19:08] So would you say that this communication is good for you Mr. [Name]?

Speaker: [00:19:13] Yes, I would say so.

Interviewer: [00:19:14] Why?

Speaker: [00:19:18] I mean, from my point of view, at least in my own ideal, I think this is realized within the framework of an ideal. I feel happy, I feel peaceful, I feel happy in general. I think I can be understood.

Speaker: [00:19:40] That's why.

Interviewer: [00:19:46] So did this relationship change you?

Speaker: [00:19:50] So of course it has changed. Because when I started this relationship I was in high school, you know, I was a teenager.

Speaker: [00:19:59] From that time to this time, whether I was in a relationship or not, there would probably be a personality change anyway. But I can say that I grew up with my girlfriend in that period. So I think it probably changed not only me but both of us. In a good way, of course, yes.

Interviewer: [00:20:23] Well, you talked a little bit about how it changed, but if you could elaborate a little bit more, I would appreciate it.

Speaker: [00:20:36] Well, for example, I am a very anxious person. You know, I am a very obsessive person at times.

Speaker: [00:20:43] I think I was able to get rid of some of that, for example.

Speaker: [00:20:50] So I can say that I have become a little bit more, how should I say, a calm person. I mean, I can simply say that.

Interviewer: [00:21:00] I mean, I don't want to make you repeat yourself again, but you said that your partner also changed because you started in high school. Did he change during that relationship and if so, how did he change? I'm going to ask that and also...

Speaker: [00:21:23] I mean, let me say it from both of our perspectives in life. I mean, it could also be because we grew up together. For example, the things we wanted to do developed together. If we were thinking about things, if we were making plans for the future, these also developed in the same partnership. Maybe there are things she thought individually before me. Things she wanted to do. But there are changes because we want to meet on common ground. It may have changed in this way.

Interviewer: [00:22:08] So do you feel safe in this relationship?

Speaker: [00:22:13] Yes, I do.

Interviewer: [00:22:15] Do you want to explain a little bit why you say that?

Speaker: [00:22:23] I can say this. You know, I told you that I am a bit of an obsessive person and so on. I mean, I was at a level that I could characterize myself as a coward in a period, maybe even at the beginning of the relationship. I mean by saying coward is my phobic style. This made me a little insecure towards life. So it was a little uneasiness, it was within the framework of cowardice. So after I started the relationship, I felt that there was a support behind me, that there was a person behind me who could give me confidence even if I had to approach life like this. Therefore, I can say that I can feel safe.

Interviewer: [00:23:18] Now I'm going to ask you a few questions, but I think it might be more accurate and easier for you to ask them by visualizing them. Very sorry, with paper, actually I think you are a [Major] student.

Speaker: [00:23:35] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:23:35] So you know, you know, the scales that we use. The scales are in front of me, by the way. I was looking for it on my desk. I will ask you by visualizing it.

Speaker: [00:23:55] I'm not very familiar with the scales because I haven't taken many of their courses. I'm still a [year] student right now?

Interviewer: [00:24:00] It doesn't matter.

Speaker: [00:24:02] Ha ok ok okay.

Interviewer: [00:24:02] Well, actually

Speaker: [00:24:03] Okay, okay

Interviewer: [00:24:04] I will show you.

Speaker: [00:24:05] Okay

Interviewer: [00:24:05] If I asked you if my partner really listens to me. On a scale of one not true at all to nine completely true, what would your answer be?

Speaker: [00:24:17] I can say nine.

Interviewer: [00:24:22] Okay. We have another question. I hope you can see. If I were to ask you that my partner is usually sensitive to my needs, again, what would your answer be on a scale of one not true at all and nine completely true?

Speaker: [00:24:42] I would call it seven.

Interviewer: [00:24:49] Yes, in our first question, you gave me the answer of nine, usually in listens. I'm actually going to ask you why you gave nine.

Speaker: [00:25:02] So when there's something that needs to be listened to or when I'm explaining something, I mean I definitely think that she can really listen and understand.

Interviewer: [00:25:16] Okay, this. Please go ahead. I'm sorry.

Speaker: [00:25:19] I mean I can understand that there was no such fake listening.

Interviewer: [00:25:27] Can you give concrete examples of these things happening? You know, whenever it happens?

Speaker: [00:25:39] For example, sometimes I have things that I worry about. Things related to my life or our relationship. There are situations where I feel the need to share this. When I share them, I usually feel that they are listened to very carefully and she can be solution-oriented. That's why.

Interviewer: [00:26:06] So why nine and not eight for this question?

Speaker: [00:26:12] So just because I think this is completely flawless.

Interviewer: [00:26:23] In your other question I asked you that my partner is usually sensitive to my needs and you answered seven. In the same way, we will ask you why you answered seven.

Speaker: [00:26:36] For example, sometimes I have a need and at the same time she has a need. You know, it doesn't always coincide, but there are times when it does.

Speaker: [00:26:49] So if it's always my needs, for example, if they are fulfilled, if my wants are fulfilled, it becomes a one-sided situation. So it's not always mine. It's not always her needs. But they don't always overlap either. So when they overlap, they are usually resolved. When they don't overlap, it's the same. That's why I decided to say seven.

Interviewer: [00:27:16] So can you give some concrete examples of when this happened again?

Speaker: [00:27:25] Well, for example, for the simplest example, there is something that I need to do or I need help with. But at the same time, my girlfriend may have to work at that time. She may not be able to help. Or she may be far away from me.

Speaker: [00:27:49] She helps as much as she can. But sometimes, you know, there are such situations that she really can't. So that's why I can say seven.

Interviewer: [00:28:02] Yeah, lastly on that question, why did you think seven was appropriate and not six or eight?

Speaker: [00:28:11] 7 was very accurate on the scale. I thought it might be a little bit more inaccurate if it went to six. That's why.

Interviewer: [00:28:21] So why not eight?

Speaker: [00:28:25] I thought eight might be a little high for that, you know, nine is a very close to perfect number, you know, eight is close to it. So I think my decision was accurate.

Interviewer: [00:28:45] Yes. I hope you don't mind me asking and if this is a sensitive topic for you to share please feel free to say so but I also wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. How often do you have sexual intercourse these days?

Speaker: [00:29:05] Not very often at the moment.

Speaker: [00:29:07] By the way, it's not something that I want to share a lot, if it's not misunderstood.

Interviewer: [00:29:17] Of course, you can say I don't want to answer this question.

Speaker: [00:29:26] Okay

Interviewer: [00:29:26] We are actually doing a voluntary video. If you do not want to share, please, we will not answer directly. My other question is the same way, taking this into consideration, please answer if you want to answer.

Speaker: [00:29:39] Okay, got it.

Interviewer: [00:29:40] My other question is how satisfied are you with your sex life, but like I said, I mean, please don't feel like you have to.

Speaker: [00:29:48] I think I'm quite satisfied.

Interviewer: [00:29:55] Okay. Mr. [Name], I think you can see that there is a 40-minute period in the zoom.

Speaker: [00:30:05] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:30:06] I actually don't want to interrupt you. If you wish, because I'm not sure you can make it in 8 minutes. There are a few questions left, but as I said

Speaker: [00:30:18] Okay, I can come in and out.

Interviewer: [00:30:20] Exactly. If that's okay with you too. Now let's take a very short break. Like one or two minutes or as long as you see fit. I am from another e-mail address

Speaker: [00:30:30] I can continue right now.

Interviewer: [00:30:33] Okay. Then let's do it like this. Let's continue with a second part through another zoom address, so that we don't actually interrupt ourselves.

Speaker: [00:30:48] Okay.

Interviewer: [00:30:48] Then I will see you in a couple of minutes. I will actually contact you on whatsapp with a new link.

Speaker: [00:30:54] All right.

Interviewer: [00:30:56] Thank you very much.

Speaker: [00:30:57] Okay. You're welcome.

Interviewer: [00:30:58] Goodbye, see you in a minute or two.

Speaker: [00:31:01] See you soon.

12B - Sinem_5-10_High_Median-High_Partner2_PART2

Interviewer:

Speaker:

Interviewer: [00:00:00]

Speaker: [00:00:00]

Interviewer: [00:00:03] Yes, and another question I'm actually going to ask you is, how satisfied are you with your relationship in general? I am completely dissatisfied and completely satisfied. Which one would you consider appropriate for your relationship?

Speaker: [00:00:23] I can say that I am very pleased.

Interviewer: [00:00:37] If I were to actually ask you a final question like this, how would you rate the satisfaction of your relationship between zero being not satisfied at all and ten being completely satisfied?

Speaker: [00:00:56] I can say nine for this too.

Interviewer: [00:01:00] Thank you. Sorry, my computer froze

Speaker: [00:01:13] Uh-huh.

Interviewer: [00:01:19] Yes, why did you answer nine?

Speaker: [00:01:22] Actually, I could have said at 10, I didn't say because I mean, of course we can have disagreements in our lives, like any two people can have disagreements. As a result, we can fight. You know, it's not something I like very much, to be honest, fighting. In general, I prefer to avoid conflict more. I mean, I can say that I don't like fighting environments. But as I said, as I said, we are human, things can happen. But of course, something I don't like and something I don't like creates dissatisfaction. Therefore, I can say that I deducted one point. But not as little as eight. Other than that, I am satisfied, so there is satisfaction with everything.

Interviewer: [00:02:14] So, did your relationship meet your expectations?

Speaker: [00:02:19] Yes.

Interviewer: [00:02:29] Finally, my last question to you actually, I'll ask you today, how comfortable were you in talking about these issues?

Speaker: [00:02:36] Normally, I don't talk about my relationships with people around me, it's not something I share much. You know, since the relationship is generally between two people, I don't prefer to share it much, to be honest. So this was a bit of a different experience. Because it's something I don't talk about much. If I talk about my relationship, I usually talk to my partner. I rarely talk to my friends in such situations. So I wasn't overly comfortable. Because it was something a little different for me. Because of that.

Interviewer: [00:03:12] Yes, Mr. [Name], we are about to finish. I would like to summarize what we actually talked about in the last hour. You are [21-25] years old. [Portion Redacted] Respect is very important to you and high quality in a relationship means a relationship where love and respect, understanding and communication are together. In love, you have actually expressed it a little bit as happiness and peace and knowing that you will not be judged. You talked about the value of communication, understanding and empathy to sustain the relationship. And you mentioned that you actually grew up together with your girlfriend and that there is more and more common ground. Was that true or is there anything you would like to add?

Speaker: [00:04:21] That's right. You know, there is nothing different that I can think of at the moment.

Speaker: [00:04:27] You know, maybe there were things that could be added as we think about it, but you know, during this period of time, these are true.

Interviewer: [00:04:35] Thank you very much indeed.

Speaker: [00:04:37] You're welcome

Interviewer: [00:04:39] Especially for you, as you said, the topics that are not mentioned much and the time and attention you spend with us is very valuable for us.

Interviewer: [00:04:52] Now, before we finish, I would like to talk a little bit about the data storage. As a research project we want to be as transparent as ethically possible. Therefore, we would like you to decide which data paraphrasing option is most suitable for you. The first option is to share parts of the transcript of our interview. None of these transcripts will contain any information that could identify you. In this way, our de-identified interview transcript can be read by other researchers. The second option, if you don't mind and if you want to be a bit bolder, is to share the entire interview transcript, stripped of sensitive and overly identifying details, i.e. completely anonymized. In this option, there is a slim chance that someone who knows you very well will be able to piece together the details of the interview transcript and narrow down who you are among your colleagues. Again, I would like to emphasize that no sensitive one or two will be shared in this option. Which option would you prefer?

Speaker: [00:06:00] I would like to choose the first option if it is suitable.

Interviewer: [00:06:03] Sure. Again, thank you very much for participating in this study.

Speaker: [00:06:09] You're welcome.

Interviewer: [00:06:10] I want you to know that this study has also been done in the Philippines, Brazil, the Netherlands, France and the United States.

Interviewer: [00:06:16] In order for this study to be successful, there is one last thing we would like to ask you, if that's okay with you. Can you nominate two close people in your life? We will also ask them to suggest other couples who might be interested in this study.

Interviewer: [00:06:30] We're also going to ask them, we're going to ask them for couples that you don't know or have not been in contact with. So we want to get as diverse a pool of participants as possible. Is this also suitable for you?

Speaker: [00:06:46] Yes, that's fine.

Interviewer: [00:06:48] Okay. Thank you very much. Then I can actually contact you via WhatsApp if these people accept.

Speaker: [00:06:59] All right.

Interviewer: [00:07:00] On this topic. I mean, we already talk about it on WhatsApp. But it would be great if you could give them a little information about this work in advance so that when you contact them, they don't leave us unanswered.

Interviewer: [00:07:15] Thank you very much indeed.

Speaker: [00:07:16] You're welcome.

Interviewer: [00:07:18] I'm going to close the recording at your convenience.

Speaker: [00:07:21] All right.

Interviewer: [00:07:23] If there is nothing you want to say on the record. Okay, then I'll close it.